Definitions:

Room: Area that players can hide in at any point.

Hallway: A path connecting two rooms.

Play Grid: A graph network of rooms as nodes and hallways as edges.

Round: A period of time in which players can move freely about the grid.

Game: A defined number of rounds.

Freeze: At the end of a round, everyone has to freeze in place.

Freezeframe: State of the play grid (player locations) at any given timestep, not necessarily at a freeze.

Player: Someone who is hiding and/or seeking in the play grid.

Score: The number of points a player has for a given round.

Chest: An object that contains coins and is hidden in a room at the start of a round. It cannot be moved.

Coin: A token that a player can pick up if they are among the first group of players to enter the room with the chest. They hold onto it until the end of the round.

Higher-up: A player with a score exactly one greater than your score.

Seeker: A player that ties for or has the sole highest score.

Elimination: If a player is in the same room as a higher-up at a freeze, they are eliminated. That means they sit out the next round of the game. When they rejoin, their score is reset to 1.

Score upgrade: If a player with score 1 has a coin during a freeze and is not eliminated, their score increases by one. If a higher-up eliminates at least one player, their score increases by 1.

Winning: The seekers after the scores are updated at the end of the last round of the game are declared the winners.

Gameplay

All players initialize with score 1 in the first round. The first group to find the chest get promoted to score 2 for the next round, and become seekers. In general, people hide from higher-ups and chase people with a score exactly one lower than their score. The seekers at the end of the game win.